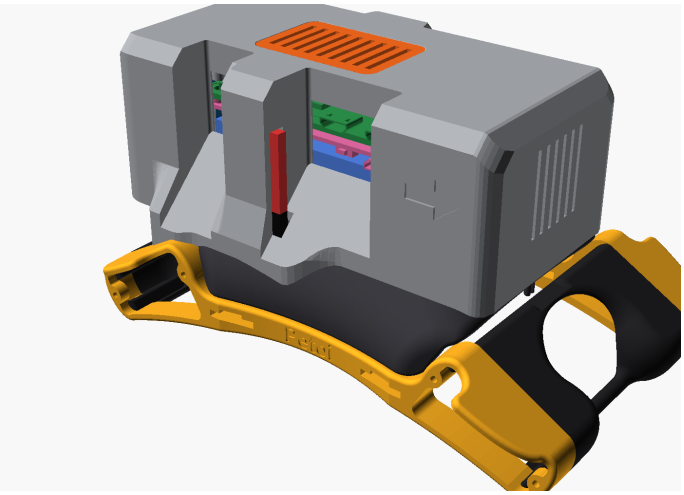
Bittle X Pi Add-on v0.15 - Build Guide

Version 0.15, 2026-10-15. A sample add-on for the Bittle X platform v3.0 (../bittle_platform). It carries a Raspberry Pi Zero 2 W with a PiSugar 2 (1200 mAh), an NS4168 I2S amp with a 3 W speaker, and an SPH0645 I2S mic. It clicks onto the platform pegs. The teardrop keyholes and the arrows on the tray and the lid show the front: the tray and the lid go on one way only. No tools, glue, tape or supports are necessary.



The add-on on the platform, right side: the two port bays.

1. Parts to print

File (stl/print/)	Material	Orientation	Supports	Cura profile	Mass
pod_tray.stl	PLA or PETG	floor on the bed	none	Bittle Pi Pod - PLA 0.25	12 g
pod_lid.stl	PLA	upside down: flat top on the bed	none	Bittle Pi Pod 0.25, or Bittle Fine 0.10 for the best surface	35 g
top_insert.stl	PLA, second color	upside down: top on the bed	none	Bittle Fine 0.10	1 g
cover_pegs_foot.stl (../bittle_platform)	PLA	stand on the rear end	none: the foot is the support	Bittle Cover - PLA 0.25	11 g

Print quality. Every surface of the add-on parts is at 45 deg or less from vertical, or is a short bridge:

1 Tray: 6 mm² of overhang in total. These are the flat bottoms (1.0 wide) of the amp pins. The speaker pins have a 45 deg point at the bottom.

2 Lid: 38 mm² in total. These are the tops (in the print) of the camera cable slot (a 6 mm bridge), the speaker grille slots and the 0.6 mm deep side arrows. The profiles have the bridge settings on. The floors of the port bays are 45 deg slopes.

3 The mic holes in the left lid wall are diamonds, so they print clean without a bridge.

4 The slots for the mic board and the speaker ear plate are vertical in the print. They have no ceilings.

5 Keep the seam at the back (the profiles do this).

2. Electronics

Part	Notes
Raspberry Pi Zero 2 W	No header. Solder the wires to the pads, flat along the GPIO edge.
PiSugar 2, 1200 mAh	Under the Pi (pogo pins and its screws). The charge port, button and switch face the right side.
NULLLAB NS4168 I2S amp	38.4 x 22.4 mm board, on edge, crosswise behind the stack, on two pins. Components to the rear.
NULLLAB 3 W 4 ohm speaker	Ear plate 45 x 31 x 1.5, body 27 x 30 x 14.3 (ruler). On two pins at the front, sound to the front grille.
HiLetgo SPH0645 I2S mic	16.7 x 12.7 x 1.8 board, on edge on the left side, beside the GPIO edge of the Pi, port to the left. Solder the wires at the top edge.
5 Dupont jumpers	Straight plugs on the BiBoard header (GND, +5V, TX2, RX2) in the cover slot.
Petoi AI Vision Module (optional)	Stays in the head. Its Grove cable goes along the left side of the robot and through the slot in the left lid wall to the Pi.

Balance. The add-on weighs about 118 g: the printed parts in PLA and typical masses of the electronics. Its center of mass is 9.9 mm behind the robot center, -0.5 mm right of the center line and 15 mm above the cover top. The speaker at the front balances the Pi stack. The masses are not weighed: put your own values in MASS_G in pod.py and run pod.py again.

3. Assembly

The 3D viewer shows each step with animation: https://beetlebugorg.github.io/bittlex/viewer/#step=1. Each step below has a link to its view.

1 Print the platform cover and fit it on the robot in place of the stock cover. (viewer step 2)

2 Solder the wires to the Pi, the amp and the mic (section 4). Give the 4 BiBoard wires about 40 mm of slack: it folds into the wire path over the Pi.

3 Build the add-on on the bench. Push the mic board down into the slot at the left side of the tray, port to the left. (viewer step 5)

4 Push the amp onto its two pins behind the stack, components to the rear. (viewer step 6)

5 Hang the speaker on the two pins of the front wall, ear plate to the rear. (viewer step 7)

6 Put the Pi + PiSugar 2 stack into the tray, battery down, ports to the right. (viewer step 8)

7 Lay the BiBoard wires in the wire path over the Pi. Their Dupont plugs stay out through the notch in the tray floor. (viewer step 9)

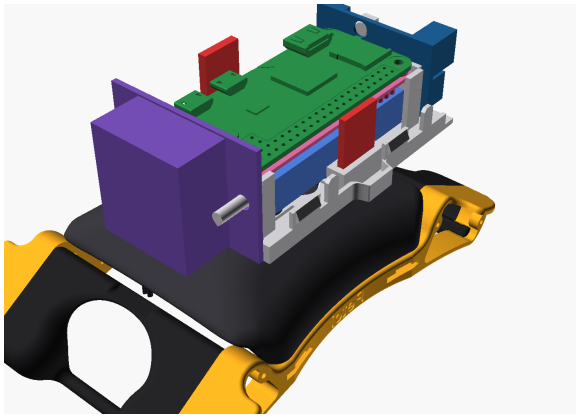
8 Push the vent insert into the window in the lid top until its 4 clips click.

9 Put the lid on, side arrows to the front. The two pairs of ribs on its left wall go down at each side of the key tabs. Push it down until the 4 snaps click. (viewer step 10)

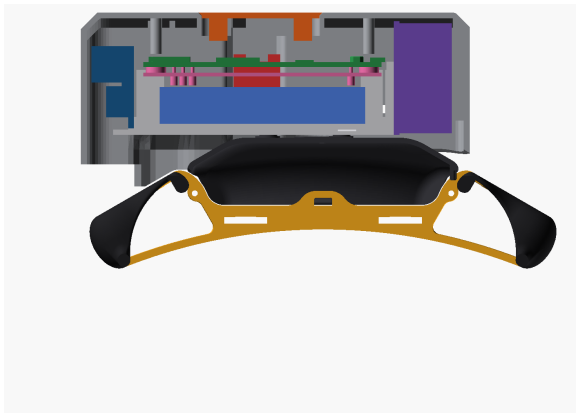
10 Fit: hold the closed add-on just above the robot and push the Dupont plugs onto the BiBoard header. Put the add-on on the pegs 7 mm behind its place, arrows to the front. Slide it 7 mm forward until it clicks. (viewer step 3) (viewer step 4)

11 Optional camera: put the Grove cable through the slot in the left lid wall before the lid goes on, and plug it into the camera module in the head.

12 Remove: slide the closed add-on 7 mm rearward, lift it a little, and pull the Dupont plugs off the header. Only open the lid on the bench.



The tray without the lid: the speaker (front), the stack on the center line, the mic (left) and the amp (rear).



Section on the center line (right: front). The speaker hangs on the front pins. The amp stands behind the stack.

4. Wiring

Signal	Pi Zero 2 W	To
UART TX / RX	GPIO14 pin 8 / GPIO15 pin 10	BiBoard RX2 / TX2
GND	pin 6	BiBoard GND
I2S BCLK	GPIO18 pin 12	amp BCLK and mic BCLK
I2S LRCLK	GPIO19 pin 35	amp LRCLK and mic LRCL
I2S out / in	GPIO21 pin 40 / GPIO20 pin 38	amp DIN / mic DOUT (mic SEL to GND)
Power	5V pin 2, 3V3 pin 1, GND pin 9	amp 5V, mic 3V. Do not connect BiBoard 5V to the Pi.
Speaker	-	amp + / - to the speaker
Camera I2C (Grove)	SDA GPIO2 pin 3, SCL GPIO3 pin 5, 3V3 pin 17, GND pin 14	AI Vision Module Grove: SDA, SCL, VCC, GND

5. Files

File	Content
stl/print/	the parts in print orientation
cad/pod_tray.step, cad/top_insert.step	exact CAD (the lid is a mesh: its lower edge follows the robot)
cad/assembly_step.zip	one STEP file with the robot, the platform and the add-on in place, with named and colored parts. Unzip it and open it in FreeCAD or other CAD software
stl/installed/, stl/models/	the parts and the electronics in the robot frame
pod.py	all dimensions, the build and the checks (fit, slide path, loose pieces, overhang)
render.py, docs.py	the pictures and this guide

Slide and lid. The closed add-on slides off to the rear: the head is 1.35 mm in front of the lid, but the 7 mm to the rear are clear. Key tabs and ribs hold the lid on the tray in Z, and the snap bumps stand 0.7 mm into the lid wall (25 deg lead-in, 45 deg catch).

Ports. The stack is on the center line for balance, so its port edge is 11 mm inside the body side. The lid has two open port bays in its right side: the wall steps in to 0.45 mm from the port faces. The front bay has the PiSugar charge port and button and the Pi power and data USB ports. The rear bay has the Pi mini-HDMI port and the PiSugar switch. The bays take plug bodies of 11 x 7.5 mm (micro-USB) and 14 x 8.5 mm (mini-HDMI). To remove the SD card, remove the lid and lift the stack out (the wires stay on): the amp is 0.2 mm behind the card.

Robot motion. The 3D viewer has the full robot (Petoi ROS model) with sliders for the head, the hips and the knees. The head turns from -45 to 45 deg without contact. Past that, the bottom of the head touches the lid front. The legs touch the add-on only when a thigh swings up over the back. The Petoi tail, if your robot has it, touches the rear of the lid.

Open items: the speaker sound face is assumed opposite the ears. The mic port is assumed at the board center; the 7 holes cover ±2.2 mm. The camera supply voltage is not checked: if the module needs 5 V, use pin 4. The PiSugar 2 LEDs are between the two boards and are not visible with the lid on. The BiBoard header height is an estimate.

6. License

The printed parts, the drawings and this guide are CC BY 4.0, and the code is MIT (Jeremy Collins). The Pi Zero and PiSugar 2 fit models are from github.com/PiSugar/PiSugar (GPL-3.0). The Petoi parts are from github.com/PetoiCamp/NonCodeFiles, without a stated license. LICENSE.md and ATTRIBUTION.md in the repository give the details.